

choices. For [P4], personalization could involve [P5], helping the customer interpret options relevant to stated needs. Customization could allow [P6], changing the service itself rather than just the information shown. In insurance, explain how a selected limit or deductible changes protection and out-of-pocket exposure. A lower price is not necessarily better if the coverage no longer fits the customer. Both approaches should support informed decisions. Use necessary data, explain its purpose, allow customers to control and avoid concealing alternatives. Risk levels include intrusive tracking, inaccurate recommendations, excessive choice and operational costs of delivering configurations. Evaluate relevance, task success, satisfaction, conversion and returns or complaints. Tailoring succeeds when it improves suitability without sacrificing trust. For example, a retailer could use a stated preference for a particular style to rank relevant items, while steering the shopper toward choices that are more profitable. The retailer could also use a stated preference for a particular style to rank relevant items, while steering the shopper toward choices that are more profitable. The retailer could also use a stated preference for a particular style to rank relevant items, while steering the shopper toward choices that are more profitable. REPLACEMENTS: Product + insurance: P1 named product retailer; P2 recommending suitable styles from stated preferences and browsing history; P3 selecting offered colours, materials or personalization text; P4 named insurer; P5 highlighting policy options using disclosed needs and relevant circumstances; P6 selecting offered coverage limits, optional benefits and deductible levels. Product + travel: P1 named retailer; P2 recommending compatible items from purchase history; P3 selecting offered size, fit or configuration; P4 named insurer; P5 recommending destinations or stays matching stated interests and budget; P6 selecting dates, room type and available add-ons. General: P1 actual shop; P2 data-informed relevant recommendations; P3 available product configurations; P4 actual service; P5 guidance based on stated needs; P6 available service options. Deductible = customer borne amount under policy terms. Verify options; use could for proposals, not invented existing features. Digital service pair: P1 named online shop; P2 recommending relevant items using stated needs or purchase history; P3 selecting available product features; P4 named digital shop; P5 highlighting suitable content or plans using stated preferences and usage history; P6 selecting offered plan features, quality, speed, delivery and payment terms. Verification, structured information, transparent changes, reliable status updates and dispute support should address these barriers. Q4 - B2B MARKETPLACE QUESTION CUES - CHOOSE Q4: marketplace; attract suppliers/brands/buyers; join platform; benefits to both sides; network effects; participation. Use 4.1 for recruitment effort and 4.2 for value/concerns. 4.1 Which side should join first? I would begin by recruiting a focused group of [J2] to [J1], using their [J3] to attract [J4]. This includes the chicken-and-egg problem: buyers hesitate without useful supply, and suppliers hesitate without credible demand. The initial participants must offer something the opposite side genuinely wants, rather than simply increasing registrations. Start in one category or market, verify participants and prepare current listings with clear availability and terms. Recruit suitable buyers and support initial transactions. Successful orders demonstrate value, attracting further supply and buyers. Improve offerings over established ordering methods. The goal is liquidity: suitable matches resulting in completed exchanges. Buyer-first recruitment would be preferable if committed anchor buyers provide the stronger attraction. Thus the recommended order follows case evidence, not a universal suppliers-first rule. Onboarding help or temporary incentives should lead to lasting value rather than dependence on subsidies. 4.2 Value and concerns for both sides. For [J4], the platform offers [J5]. Centralizing discovery and coordination reduces search and transaction effort and can widen access beyond existing contacts. Buyers may worry about identity, quality, delivery and payment terms. Verification, structured information, transparent changes, reliable status updates and dispute support should address these barriers. For [J2], it offers [J6]. Suppliers may worry about bids, uncertain orders, unsuitable customers, presentation control, pricing pressure and confidential data. Explain fees and data rights, quality buyers and provide usable order tools. Access to an audience is valuable only if it brings worthwhile business; suppliers need evidence of conversion and manageable servicing costs. Both groups require trustworthy rights, security and responsive support. Pilot the marketplace before expanding, measuring activity, qualified participants, match-order completion, repeat transactions, cancellations and disputes. More users help only when they improve useful choice and dependable exchange. Expansion should follow demonstrated liquidity and sustainable participant value. In a B2B setting, participation decisions may involve purchasing managers, finance teams and existing supplier contacts. Onboarding should therefore demonstrate compatibility with current workflows, clear commercial terms and a control improvement over established ordering methods. A targeted pilot with trusted firms can establish evidence before wider recruitment. Retention matters as much as signup: if participants return to off-platform arrangements because costs outweigh benefits, nominal membership does not create a successful marketplace. Monitor both sides separately so growth in one group does not conceal dissatisfaction in the other. REPLACE J1-J6 USING ONE SET: General business services marketplace: J1 named platform; J2 comparable suppliers with relevant inventory; J3 differentiated products and reliable availability; J4 qualified business buyers; J5 searchable supplier choice, comparable commercial terms and simple ordering; J6 access to qualified demand, wider market coverage and less order administration. General B2B: J1 named platform; J2 established brands with suitable collections; J3 current collections and wholesale terms; J4 retail buyers; J5 collection discovery, assortment comparison and coordinated wholesale orders; J6 retailer access, clear merchandising and streamlined order handling. Accommodation: J1 named platform; J2 verified hosts; J3 accurately described available stays; J4 guests; J5 comparable stays, transparent charges and reliable reservation support; J6 relevant guest demand and booking/payment tools. Services: J1 named platform; J2 qualified providers; J3 clearly scoped services and availability; J4 customers; J5 provider comparison and easier scheduling; J6 customer discovery and booking/payment support. Accommodation/services are not automatically B2B: classify actual parties and adapt concerns. General business-services marketplace: J1 named platform; J2 qualified firms offering services; J3 clearly specified capabilities and availability; J4 organizations seeking those services; J5 easier provider discovery, proposal comparison and project coordination; J6 access to relevant business demand and tools for proposals, scheduling or payment. Adapt to the actual platform functions and the side with stronger initial attraction.	
Q5 - WEBSITE/APP EXPERIENCE QUESTION CUES - CHOOSE Q5: evaluate website/app; user experience; design factors; usability; navigation; checkout; preferred app; improve shopping. Describe task, apply eight factors, identify weaknesses, propose improvement and measures. I choose [U1] because its experience can be evaluated through the complete shopping task: locating a suitable offering, checking its fit, committing to purchase and receiving support. [U2] assist discovery, [U3] support evaluation, [U4] support informed commitment, and [U5] reduce uncertainty afterwards. These stages must connect coherently: effective search cannot compensate for incomplete details or unexpected charges at checkout. Apply the eight design factors. Functionality: pages, filters and payment work reliably and load quickly. Informational design: accurate details, prices and policies are easy to locate. Ease of use: labels and controls make the next step understandable. Redundant navigation: search, categories and other routes reach the same content. Ease of purchase: remove unnecessary steps and show the complete order before payment. Multi-browser functionality: website tasks work across common browsers, and tasks should work on supported devices. Simple graphics: visuals explain rather than distract. Legible text: appropriate size, spacing and contrast make information readable. Responsive layouts, usable touch targets and accessibility extend these benefits to mobile users and people with different abilities. Secure payment, visible total charges, delivery/return terms and contact options build confidence. Order status and responsive assistance complete the experience. Reliability of demand is essential: attractive screens offer little value when transactions fail. A limitation is that [U6] I would improve [U7], prioritizing the obstacle that most directly harms the task. Compare the relevant and existing design through realistic tasks or A/B testing, measuring search success, completion time, errors, abandonment, conversion and satisfaction. Check complaints and returns as well: more purchases do not prove improvement if customers misunderstand the offering. The strongest design helps customers make suitable decisions with less effort. I would substantiate each judgment with an actual task, such as finding an item within a budget, checking its suitability and completing an order. Observe where users hesitate or make errors rather than inferring usability from visual appeal. Useful recovery features include editable selections, clear validation messages and a route back without losing progress. These reduce the cost of mistakes. Prioritize transparent pricing and reliable task completion before decorative additions. The final recommendation should state why the chosen change addresses the observed weakness and how evidence would show that it improves both customer understanding and the business outcome. REPLACE U1-U7 USING ONE SET: Retail: U1 actual app; U2 relevant search, categories and filters; U3 clear specifications, images and genuine reviews; U4 editable cart and transparent checkout; U5 delivery tracking and accessible support; U6 poorly explained filters; can leave customers comparing unsuitable items; U7 filter labels and visibility of selected criteria. Accommodation: U1 actual app; U2 destination, date and guest filters; U3 accurate photos, amenities, policies and reviews; U4 full booking-price breakdown and reservation confirmation; U5 complete status and history; U6 transparent cancellation charges; U7 clear cancellation policies; U8 complete stay prices and cancellation terms earlier in the journey. Services: U1 actual app; U2 provider, task and availability search; U3 clear scope, qualifications, ratings and terms; U4 scheduling review and payment confirmation; U5 booking updates and problem resolution; U6 ambiguous availability can cause failed booking attempts; U7 current slots and clear cancellation status. Use observed features/responses only: state hypothetical issues conditionally. General e-commerce website: U1 actual website; U2 relevant search and clear category routes; U3 accurate offering details, prices and applicable terms; U4 editable order review and clear payment steps; U5 confirmation, status updates and support; U6 missing or inconsistent information can make selection uncertain; U7 information consistency; U8 clear shipping, listings and checkout. Use this weakness only if observed; otherwise substitute the actual obstacle.	
PART C - READING ANSWER BANK (R1-R10) Exam scope: R1-R10. R11 and R12 excluded. Choose the right evidence language. For R2, distinguish the authors' arguments from verified empirical findings. For reviews (R1/R3/R4/R10), describe synthesized arguments without inventing new participants. For experiments (R5/R6), note actual conditions and how they affect results. For the R7/R8 surveys and R9 panel, state associations and avoid universal causal claims. Purchase intention, browser stickiness and ranked visibility are different outcomes from actual sales. A strong critique names the specific gap and how further evidence could resolve it, rather than saying only "more research is needed."	
R1 - Transformation of Dropshipping in Digital Commerce QUESTION KEYWORDS: dropshipping; inventory; supplier; fulfillment; low entry barriers; hybrid model. Authors: Dayla & Maheshwari Q: Main argument and how the model works.	
Dropshipping is a retail fulfillment model in which the seller markets and sells products without holding them in stock. After receiving an order, it purchases from a supplier that ships directly to the customer. The seller earns the difference between selling revenue and supplier, delivery, marketing and other costs. The paper argues that digital platforms, automation and data-driven marketing have made this model easier to enter and operate, but long-term sustainability requires reliable suppliers and a strong customer experience. Q: Benefits, challenges and recommended strategy. Benefits include lower initial inventory investment, reduced unsold-stock risk, flexible product testing, wider assortment and location flexibility. However, low entry barriers increase competition, while the seller has limited control over quality, availability, delivery and returns. Multiple suppliers can create split shipments and higher costs. I would select and monitor dependable suppliers, synchronize stock levels and returns, realistic delivery/return terms, and focus on a niche rather than compete only on price. Automation can reduce manual errors; analytics can support demand and marketing decisions. Hybrid fulfillment can keep popular items locally while dropping other items, trading some inventory cost for delivery reliability. Q: Evidence, implications and limits. This is a qualitative secondary-data analysis of literature and industry sources, not an experiment proving profitability. Private labelling, social commerce, sustainable sourcing and hybrid fulfillment are discussed as developments. Track delivery reliability, stock cancellations, returns, acquisition cost, customer satisfaction and contribution margin. The lesson is that inventory savings transfer operational dependence to suppliers; they do not remove business risk. Reference: Dayla and Maheshwari (2026). Compared with inventory-holding retail, the central trade-off is less stock investment versus less direct fulfillment control. Test supplier performance before scaling and consider redesigning contracts, shipping fees, return policies and customer support. The retailer retains the customer-facing party even when another firm ships the item. Low setup cost is therefore an entry advantage, not evidence of easy or guaranteed profit.	
R2 - Cloud Computing Empowering E-Commerce Innovation QUESTION KEYWORDS: cloud; scalability; on-demand resources; Iaas/PaaS/SaaS; innovation; security; customer experience; sustainability. Authors: Akrami & Bhatnal Q: Main argument and cloud service models. Akrami and Bhatnal argue that cloud computing supports e-commerce innovation through shared, virtualized resources delivered on demand. Infrastructure cloud provides computing/storage; platform cloud supports application development; application cloud supplies hosted software, commonly SaaS. Renting resources can lower upfront infrastructure investment and make expansion more flexible. The contribution is an explanation of mechanisms and opportunities, not a quantified demonstration that every cloud adopter becomes profitable. Q: Benefits, applications and recommendations. Elastic resources can accommodate fluctuating traffic; pay-as-you-use provision changes setup/maintenance costs; online access supports customers across locations and devices. Cloud services can support innovation, pricing, personalization, privacy, wider storage and resource sharing support operations. The paper discusses CloudFront edge delivery, noting that it does not directly solve frequent backend database access, and SQL Azure data synchronization across locations. I would choose services according to application needs, pilot migration, test peak demand and monitor total cost of ownership. Avoid over-reliance on vendor lock-in. Clear communication and recommendations can improve experience when implementation is reliable. Q: Risks, evidence and limitations. Security/privacy, data ownership, consumer rights and cloud-system vulnerabilities require attention. Backup and geographical replication can improve resilience but do not guarantee safety. The paper discusses layered security and proposes encryption, authentication/access controls, load balancing/caching, mobile integration, analytics and greener resource use. Its methods describe a mixed-methods survey and qualitative triangulation, but much is future-tense; no achieved sample size, statistical data or estimates are reported. Treat the results as broad arguments, not measured causal effects. Proposed limitations include self-report/recall bias and restricted sample applicability. Reference: Akrami and Bhatnal, "Cloud computing empowering e-commerce innovation." Applied Data Science and Smart Systems, Chapter 51.	
R3 - eWOM and Consumer Buying Behaviour QUESTION KEYWORDS: electronic word-of-mouth; UGC; credibility; informativeness; trust; perceived risk; purchase intention. Authors: Bharej & Singh Q: Definition, main argument and mechanism. Electronic word-of-mouth (eWOM) is digitally shared consumer opinion or advice, including reviews, comments and recommendations. This literature review links eWOM with purchase intention through information quality, source credibility, trust and perceived value. Credible and informative customer content helps people assess alternatives and reduces uncertainty. User-generated photos and videos can provide concrete product information. Positive communication can reinforce confidence and loyalty, while negative communication can discourage purchase and reveal a service problem. Q: What should businesses do, and how would you evaluate it? Businesses should encourage genuine customer reviews, make useful details easy to find, and respond constructively to negative feedback. They should prioritize authentic, relevant and informativeness over merely maximizing the number of posts. Clear disclosure and review verification can support credibility, fabricated praise damages trust. An illustrative example is a buyer using customer photos to assess clothing before purchasing. Measure review quality and sentiment, highlight engagement, complaints and conversion, while recognizing that purchase intention is not actual sales. Q: Method, findings and limitations. The paper synthesizes studies from 2015–2025 using a systematic literature-review approach. It concludes that credibility supports trust and adoption of recommendations, while informativeness strengthens links between UGC engagement and purchase intention. These are synthesized conclusions rather than results of a new randomized consumer experiment. Effects may vary across products, platforms and sources; do not claim every review causes a purchase. Reference: Bharej and Singh (2025). Do not use "truth or source?" informality: (does the message help?), quantify (how much discussion?) and sentiment (is it positive or negative?). A large volume of vague praise need not be more persuasive than detailed, credible reviews. Responding to criticism and fixing its cause may improve service; deleting legitimate negative feedback can undermine the trust the business seeks to build.	
R4 - Content Marketing: Short-Form Video, TikTok and Beyond QUESTION KEYWORDS: short-form video; algorithmic discovery; storytelling; creators; authenticity; engagement; virality. Authors: Babu M et al. Q: Main argument and why the format matters. The paper argues that short-form video changes content marketing by combining rapid consumption, visual storytelling, mobile compatibility and participatory platform features. Discovery algorithms can expose content beyond an account's followers, while trends, challenges and creators encourage engagement. Brands can use short-form video to build brand identity, connect with target interest and connect viewers with deeper information or a purchase path. The paper discusses TikTok alongside Reels, Shorts and other short-video formats. Q: Recommend a campaign and explain benefits and risks. I would define the audience and goal, create an immediate relevant opening, show a concise product benefit, collaborate with suitable creators and use a clear call to action. A participatory challenge can invite customers to contribute their own content, as the paper's Guess and Chiptole examples illustrate. Preserve authenticity and brand consistency while allowing creator freedom. Benefits include exploration, social variety and across product or stores. It distinguishes purchase-oriented goals from information-search goals. Enjoyment is a positive experience that can encourage continued browsing; saturation is becoming tired of repeated stimulation. The study asks how these exploration modes and goals shape stickiness through enjoyment and saturation. Q: Measurement, evidence and limitations. Evaluate completion/watch time, shares, comments, qualified visits and conversions, then compare attributable outcomes with production and promotion costs. Views alone do not demonstrate ROI or loyalty. This is a discussion with campaign examples and presented comparisons, rather than a clearly identified controlled causal experiment. Treat campaign statistics as the paper's reported illustrative remarks. Reference: Babu M and colleagues (2024). A complete strategy links content to the wider journey; a short entertaining video draws attention, a landing page provides evidence, and an appropriate CTA supports conversion. Creator selection should consider audience fit and credibility, not follower count alone. Maintain a sustainable content schedule, disclose commercial relationships and test creative variants. Combine short video with deeper information for complex decisions rather than treating every format as interchangeable.	
R5 - Exploratory Behaviour and Online Shopping Stickiness QUESTION KEYWORDS: stickiness; specific/diverse exploration; purchases/search goals; enjoyment; satiation; variety. Authors: Antonio, Camarero, Oltra & Vega Q: Define concepts and explain the research question. The paper defines online shopping stickiness as the intention to prolong browsing within a shopping session, potentially across several websites. Specific exploration focuses on a store or product; diverse exploration seeks variety across products or stores. It distinguishes purchase-oriented goals from information-search goals. Enjoyment is a positive experience that can encourage continued browsing; satiation is becoming tired of repeated stimulation. The study asks how these exploration modes and goals shape stickiness through enjoyment and satiation. Q: What did it find? Using two online shopping-shopping experiments and a field study, the authors find that diverse exploration can strengthen stickiness and that product variety can be particularly useful. Enjoyment supports continued browsing, while satiation represents a negative pathway. Goal effects depend on whether the control is online and real-world purchases. Real-world purchases do not produce identical patterns. In the field, purchasing users can leave once their task is complete. Therefore, longer browsing should not automatically be interpreted as loyalty, task success or increased buying. Q: Managerial application and limitations. Retailers should match navigation to user intent: clear filters and a direct buying path for focused shoppers; varied, cross-category suggestions for explorers. For example, show complementary jeans to someone browsing hoodies rather than endless similar hoodies. Avoid artificial obstacles designed only to keep users online. Evaluate satisfaction, task completion, browsing, abandonment and purchases together. Limits include young participants, fashion products, desktop settings and simulated time-constrained tasks; future work should test mobile and natural purchases. Reference: Antonio, Camarero, Oltra and Vega (2026). The causal story proposed is that varied stimuli can create enjoyment and reduce expiation, supporting continued exploration. Yet too much variety may create decision fatigue for customers ready to buy. Design should allow movement from exploration to selection rather than force every shopper into the same route. A completed purchase in a short session can be a better outcome than a long, confusing session.	
R6 - Context-Aware Mobile Commerce Interfaces QUESTION KEYWORDS: contrast; line spacing; font; outdoor context; ease of use; purchase/visit/recommend intentions. Authors: Pelet & Taieb Q: Question, method and key findings. Pelet and Taieb examine how mobile website interface design affects perceived ease of use and behavioural intentions outdoors. A 2 × 2 × 2 experiment varied colour contrast, layout line spacing and font type on a fictional music-CD website. Questionnaire data from 560 users were analysed with environmental conditions such as sunshine, humidity and brightness considered. In this setting, light text on a dark background combined with any spacing and a sans-serif font such as Arial was	
perceived as easier to use. Ease of use was linked to greater purchase, revisit and recommendation intentions. Q: Explain the mechanism and business application. Readable layouts reduce visual effort and perceived complexity, helping customers examine products comfortably. I would test mobile designs under the actual conditions in which customers shop, including bright outdoor settings and varied devices. Provide legible text, adequate spacing and options for adjusting appearance, rather than choosing design type only for visual appeal. Use task success and perceived ease alongside behavioural outcomes when evaluating changes. Q: Limitations and safe conclusion. The experiment used one fictional CD-selling site in France, with eight interface versions and a particular climate context. It does not prove that dark backgrounds are best for every site, user or environment. Outcomes are reported intentions, not verified sales or repeat visits. The contribution is context-aware design: the environment can change which interface is easiest to use. Reference: Pelet and Taieb (2022). The variables are interface contrast, spacing/layout and font; perceived ease of use connects these decisions. Environmental conditions help interpret the outdoor setting. For practice, compare prototypes under realistic conditions and ask users to locate an item, read details and complete checkout. Measure errors/time as well as perceptions; do not infer actual purchases directly from an intention rating.	
R7 - Digital-Native Satisfaction in Q-Commerce Fashion Retail QUESTION KEYWORDS: Q-commerce; omnichannel; UTAUT; performance expectancy; effort expectation; trust; privacy; uncertainty; perceived value. Authors: Sainy, Sharma, Deb & Jasrotia Q: Question, model and method. The paper examines post-adoption satisfaction among young digital-native shoppers in Q-commerce-enabled omnichannel fashion retail. Q-commerce emphasizes fast fulfillment; omnichannel connects app, web and physical-store touchpoints. Extending UTAUT, it tests performance expectancy (usefulness), effort expectancy (ease), trust and inhibitors against perceived value and satisfaction. A sequential mixed-methods study used 24 interviews to inform a survey of 569 shoppers, analysed with PLS-SEM. Q: Findings and explanation. Performance expectancy, effort expectancy and trust positively relate to perceived value, which strongly predicts satisfaction. Privacy concerns and uncertainty reduce perceived value; situational factors were not significant in the model. The lesson is that fast service alone is insufficient: shoppers need useful, easy and dependable experiences without feeling excessively tracked. A non-significant result in this sample does not establish that situational conditions never matter. Q: Recommendations and limitations. Synchronize inventory and prices across channels, provide reliable fulfillment information, simplify checkout, explain returns and offer prompt support. Give users clear data-use information and control over personalization and notifications. For example, show accurate nearby stock and realistic delivery promises before payment. Evaluate satisfaction, value, delivery reliability, returns and repeat use. Limits include metropolitan Indian consumers, cross-sectional self-reports and a specific fashion/Q-commerce setting; the relationships are not universal causal proof. Reference: Sainy, Sharma, Deb and Jasrotia (2026). Perceived value summarizes whether the experience feels worth its monetary and non-monetary sacrifices. An easy app can still disappoint if stock information is wrong or delivery promises fail. Privacy control and uncertainty reduction should therefore accompany speed improvements. Interpret PLS-SEM as testing relationships in the proposed model; the survey design does not establish that changing one feature necessarily causes later loyalty.	
R8 - Bank-FinTech Collaboration and Service Digitalization QUESTION KEYWORDS: existing/new services; exploitation/exploration; operational agility; FinTech collaboration; standardized/customized; conditional effects. Authors: Cao, Kristal & Huang Q: Research question, concepts and method. Cao, Kristal and Huang (2026), "One Size Does Fit All," examine how digitalization, operational agility and FinTech collaboration jointly relate to retail-bank service performance. Existing-service digitalization improves established offerings; new-service digitalization creates novel ones. Highly standardized services have low customization/complexity; low-standardized services require more variety and customer input. Operational agility is rapid, flexible process reconfiguration; collaboration involves external experts and technology integration. Survey responses came from 27 Canadian retail banks and 82 credit unions. Moderated-mediation analysis tests whether indirect relationships through agility depend on collaboration. Q: Findings and why one strategy does not fit all. Digitalizing existing services improves both standardized and customized service performance; digitalizing new services benefits only standardized services in the reported results. Agility is not a universal independent performance driver. Its combination with FinTech collaboration is most useful for existing services and customized services. Standardized services benefit less from agility. For standardized existing services, excessive collaboration/agility may weaken consistency and efficiency; the same synergy is not established for novel services. Distinguish these conditional findings from a blanket claim that partnerships always improve banking. Q: Recommendation, example and limitations. I would classify services before allocating resources: digitize established processes, align partner expertise with specific customer needs and preserve consistency in routine operations. For example, an existing tailored advisory service may benefit from customer-focused FinTech input plus flexible hours and external experts and technology integration. New services require more agility. This is an application, not a reported experiment. Evaluate service performance, adoption, retention and costs. Collaboration was measured as a binary indicator, obscuring partnership form, scope and duration. Canadian market/regulatory conditions limit generalization; self-reported performance may bias results. The survey design and analysis are not universal causal findings; cross-country, longitudinal and objective measures could strengthen evidence.	
R9 - Sponsored Visibility in E-Commerce Marketplaces QUESTION KEYWORDS: sponsored search; organic signals; rank; sponsored density; retail media; concentration; transparency. Authors: Saglam Q: Question, method and results. The paper studies how sponsored listings relate to marketplace search visibility and change the visibility associated with organic signals. Its Amazon panel covers the US, UK and Germany, 96 keywords and 120 days with 1,492,650 observations. It measures sponsored density, rank and placement relative than observed customer attention or sales. Fixed-effects estimates associate sponsorship with better visibility and a 5.94 percentage-point higher chance of top-ten placement. Higher sponsored density weakens visibility associations for ratings, review volume, delivery and badges, and weakens the penalty associated with higher relative prices. Q: Why does this matter and what should businesses/platforms do? Paid placement changes which products are discoverable, so visible rankings reflect advertising access as well as product signals. Larger sellers have stronger sponsorship associations, and advertising-intensive markets show greater seller-visibility concentration. Sellers should assess ad costs and actual conversions rather than assuming good reviews alone secure discovery. Platforms should label sponsorship clearly and assess search relevance, transparency and competitive access. These recommendations balance revenue from retail media with user trust and opportunities for smaller sellers. Q: Limitations and interpretation. This is observational evidence: sponsorship is not randomly assigned, and time-varying data/platform policies may remain. Event-study patterns support the analysis but do not eliminate all confounding. The seller measure rankings, not clicks, actual attention, purchases or profit. Do not rewrite the 5.94-point visibility result as a sales increase. Reference: Saglam, supplied reading. Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services 94, article 104987. Organic signals remain relevant but their visibility associations weaken when sponsored listings occupy more of the results. This is a caution: hook on sponsored listings to discoverability, not proof that customers stop caring about quality. Separate platform revenue, seller return and customer relevance: more paid placements may benefit advertising income while intensifying seller competition. Evaluate these goals together when considering ranking design.	
R10 - Nuanced Comparison of B2B and B2C Platforms QUESTION KEYWORDS: platform ecosystem; network effects; trust; integration; incumbents; data sharing; false analogy. Authors: Feike & Rosch Q: Main argument and evidence. Feike and Rosch compare B2B platform characteristics in information-systems literature with general platform literature. They find that common features are not exclusive to B2B: both types face network effects, chicken-and-egg problems, interaction governance and data requirements. Differences are nuanced, so a successful B2C strategy should not be copied automatically into a business market. This is a literature-based comparison, not an experiment establishing five universal success factors. Q: Explain the five potential differences. First, B2B platforms often support existing business practices rather than immediately disrupt them. Second, heterogeneous business systems can require customized technical integration. Third, incumbents may establish relationships with key partners to reduce critical mass; participants may rely on balanced bargaining power, with gradual market change. Fifth, firms may need immediate benefits to share commercially sensitive data. These are proposed distinctions requiring further investigation, not absolute B2B/B2C rules. Q: Managerial implications and limitations. Start with the actual firms, workflows and platform type. Offer useful stand-alone services where appropriate, integrate existing systems, recruit trusted partners and make data-sharing benefits and governance explicit. For example, order-management value can help attract firms before transaction volume grows. Protect confidentiality, clarify data rights and manage incentives against opportunism. The review cannot determine whether differences are intrinsic or reflect strategic choices in its sample; some B2C platforms share these characteristics. Reference: Feike and Rosch (2024). Platform design addresses infrastructure, initial supply and critical mass; platform management addresses interactions and protection of value once participation exists. Trust can require contractual rules, compliance and reliable data as well as ratings. Distinguish who decides to join from who actually uses the platform inside a firm. These organizational and integration requirements help explain why consumer-site rapid expansion may need adaptation.	

PART C - ONE TAKEAWAY PER READING

R1 Dropshipping: Less inventory investment, but less fulfillment control and greater supplier dependence. **R2 Cloud:** Flexible resources to support innovation; security, implementation and total costs matter. **R3 eWOM:** Credible, useful reviews support trust and purchase intention. **R4 Short video:** Attract attention through relevant, entertaining content; views alone do not prove task success. **R5 Stickiness:** Enjoyment and variety can prolong browsing; longer browsing does not necessarily mean more purchases. **R6 Mobile interfaces:** Readability depends on context: one design is not best everywhere. **R7 Q-commerce:** Speed needs usefulness, ease, trust and reduced privacy concerns/uncertainty. **R8 Bank-FinTech:** The value of collaboration depends on the service type; one strategy does not fit all. **R9 Sponsored visibility:** Paid listings affect visibility; rating improvement is not proof of sales improvement. **R10 B2B/B2C Platforms:** Similar platform principles exist, but business integration, trust and data needs require adaptation.